Football recruiting calendar, Class of 2029

Class of 2029 · built from rules read 2026-11-05 · written 2026-11-06 · playbook id w10-football

> Education, not legal advice. Nothing here promises an offer, aid, a roster spot or playing time. We do not contact coaches or your athlete. Dates tagged **RULE** come from a bylaw we cite. **PROJECTED** means calculated from current bylaws and not yet published. **RECOMMENDED** and **YOUR PLAN** are our suggestions, not NCAA deadlines. Confirm every date with each school's compliance office.

Part A.The picture in one page

What opens	Class of 2029 date	Source
Coach calls, texts, emails to your athlete	2027-06-15 (after sophomore year)	[S1 13.1.3.1, 13.4.1]
Off-campus, in-person contact	2028-01-01 (junior year)	[S1 13.1.1.1.6]
Junior-year official visits	2028-04-01 to 2028-06-25, then from 2028-09-01	[S1 13.6.2.1.7, 13.6.3]
Written aid offer	on or after 2028-11-15 (senior year)	[S1 13.9.3.3]
Early signing period	PROJECTED 2028-11-29 to 2028-12-01	[S1 13.02.13.1(c)]
Regular signing opens	PROJECTED 2029-02-07; each school sets its own end date	[S1 13.02.13.1(e)]

What the family may do before any date opens. Nothing in these rules stops an athlete from writing a coach, filling in a questionnaire or going to a camp; the dates limit what the coach may send or say back [S26; S19]. So early outreach is allowed, early *replies* may not come. Silence before the date is the rule working, not a "no."

New for FBS (effective 2027-01-01). Bylaw 13.1.5.3 gives a school four recruiting opportunities per prospect from Jan 1 to May 31, at most one a week, two of them only at the athlete's high school; a school visit counts for every prospect there [S1 13.1.5.3, 13.1.5.3.2, 13.1.4.3]. FCS stays on the older rule: two opportunities per contact period after Jan 1 of junior year [S1]. The limit is per program, not per coach. Plan for a spring visit being scarce.

Two academic lines nothing late can repair.

1. *The 10/7 lock:* D1 needs 10 of the 16 core courses finished before the seventh semester starts, 7 of them English, math or science. Those grades lock [S1 14.3.1.1(b)].

2. *The finish:* 16 core courses, 2.300 core GPA, graduate, final transcript sent [S1 14.3.1.1(a); S6]. Core GPA is not transcript GPA.

D2 asks for a 2.2 core GPA [S7]. D3 has no NCAA minimum; the school sets it [S7].

Roster reality. D1 schools in the settlement are capped at 105 football players [S9]. A roster limit is a ceiling on team size. It is not a count of open spots and says nothing about how many freshmen a school signs [W7-recruitiq 1A; S8]. Designated student-athletes do not count toward the 105 [S10].

Honest context, not odds. About 8.1% of high school football players appear on an NCAA roster in the same year (all divisions; 3.4% D1, 2.1% D2, 2.6% D3). That is a ratio of two headcounts for 2024-25. It leaves

out NAIA and JUCO and it is not the chance for your athlete [S17]. About 2% of high school athletes receive athletics scholarships across sports [S18].

Dated calendar (each row cites its bylaw)

2026-11-15 — **Recommended (not NCAA)**

Have the counselor check every course against the NCAA list

Map completed and planned classes against your school's NCAA-approved course list. Not every class counts. This is our recommended date, not an NCAA one.

If missed: Problems found in 12th grade are often too late to fix.

D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2027-06-15 — **Opens**

D1 football coaches may start calling, texting and emailing

After sophomore year, coaches may call and send recruiting messages. Unofficial visits involving the athletics department were already allowed at any age, subject to the calendar.

If missed: None for starting later.

D1 Bylaws 13.1.3.1, 13.4.1 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2027-08-15 — **Recommended (not NCAA)**

Open the NCAA Eligibility Center certification account

D1 and D2 recruits need a certification account ($110 domestic, fee waivers possible) before any D1 official visit. The free Profile Page isn't enough. Recommended date, not an NCAA deadline.

If missed: Without it, a school can't host you on an official visit.

D1 Bylaw 13.6.3 · https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/Registration_Checklist.pdf

2028-01-01 — **Opens**

D1 off-campus contact may begin

January 1 of junior year. From January 2027, FBS schools get four recruiting opportunities per prospect between January 1 and May 31, at most one a week. That's the limit for the whole school, not per coach.

If missed: None for later contact. Earlier contact is a violation.

D1 Bylaws 13.1.1.1.6, 13.1.5.3 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2028-04-01 — **Window**

Junior-year official visit window opens

Paid visits run April 1 through the Sunday before the last Wednesday in June (2028-06-25 by the formula). They resume September 1 of senior year. Each visit needs a transcript, an Eligibility Center account and a spot on the school's list.

If missed: Miss it and visits wait until senior year.

D1 Bylaws 13.6.2.1.7, 13.6.3 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

HARD DEADLINE

Finish 10 of your 16 core courses before senior year

Division I requires 10 NCAA-approved core courses, 7 of them English, math or science, finished before the first day of the seventh semester. Those grades lock. Your school sets the exact date.

If missed: Can block qualifier status and first-year competition. Senior-year courses can't repair it.

D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(b) · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2028-11-15 — **Opens**

Written scholarship offers may arrive

Under a rule adopted October 2025, a written athletics aid offer can't be made before November 15 of senior year. A verbal offer isn't binding on either side.

If missed: Watch for verbal pressure before this date.
D1 Bylaw 13.9.3.3 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2028-11-29	***PROJECTED (not yet published)*** *Projected early signing period* *Calculated from current rules: Wednesday before the first Saturday in December, through Friday (Nov 29 to Dec 1, 2028). Not yet published.* *If missed: No eligibility loss, but scholarships commit early.* *D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1(c) · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008*
2029-02-07	***PROJECTED (not yet published)*** *Projected regular signing date* *First Wednesday in February, calculated from current rules. Each school sets its own final date. There's no universal April 1 cutoff.* *If missed: No eligibility loss for signing later.* *D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1(e) · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008*
2029-04-01	**Window** Final amateurism certification request opens Fall 2029 enrollees can request final amateurism certification in their Eligibility Center account from April 1. It's when the window opens, not a cutoff. If missed: Not an automatic loss, but waiting can delay clearance to compete. Eligibility Center procedure · https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/How_to_Request_Final_Amateurism_Certification.pdf
	HARD DEADLINE Graduate and get final certification Finish all 16 core courses with at least a 2.3 core GPA, graduate, and have the school send the final transcript to the Eligibility Center. A transcript GPA isn't the same as a core GPA. If missed: Can delay or block first-year competition. A verbal commitment isn't clearance. D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.3 · https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/IE_Brochure.pdf

The stages at a glance

Stage 0. Set up the home base (one evening, any time before 2027-06-15)
Done when: the folder exists, the Sunday slot is on both calendars, and C1 has a dollar figure written in.

Stage 1. Lock the academics (start now; recheck each semester)
Done when: C4 shows 10 of 16 reachable before the seventh-semester date, 7 of them in English/math/science, and the account number is in the folder.

Stage 2. Build film and a one-page profile (before 2027-06-15)
Done when: a stranger can open the film link on a phone in under 10 seconds, C5 fits on one page, and C6 has no open items.

Stage 3. Build the target list (before 2027-06-15)
Done when: C2 has 30 rows with every column filled or marked "unknown", and the high school coach has been asked in writing for a level read.

Stage 4. First contact (2027-06-15 opens coach replies)
Done when: 20 messages are logged, every reply has a logged answer, and no follow-up is more than 3 days overdue.

Stage 5. Camps and junior days: spend by score (Fall 2027 to Spring 2028)
Done when: every camp has a C8 row, the total spend is under the C1 ceiling, and every attended camp has a follow-up logged.

Stage 6. The visit window (off-campus contact 2028-01-01; official visits from 2028-04-01)
Done when: every visit has a C10 score dated within 24 hours.

Stage 7. Offers, comparison, signing (2028-11-15 onward)
Done when: C11 has no blank cell for the offer being accepted and the athlete has chosen with the parent at the table.

Sources used: S1, S4, S5, S6, S7, S8, S9, S10, S17, S18, S19, S26, S27, S28, S29, S31, S32, S35, S36, S37, S38, S40. Full table: `../shared/SOURCES.md`. Full source table is in the Commit Book. Education, not legal advice. Rules change; check the cited source and each school's compliance office before acting. The Recruiting Calendar.